

Shayla Reid

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Skills

- Github
- MATLAB programming
- Effective communication
- Problem solving
- Leadership
- Mathematica programming
- C#/C++ programming
- JavaScript programming
- Python programming
- Data analysis

Relevant Experience

- Undergraduate Research Intern** **06/2025 to PRESENT**
Cornell Virtual Embodiment Lab **Ithaca, NY**
- Conducted research on VR personalization methods to enhance user presence and realism, analyzing interaction data with Python and R to support lab publications.
 - Collaborated with graduate students and faculty to design, prototype, and evaluate experimental frameworks for virtual embodiment, while managing code and experiments via GitHub.
- Data Analyst Intern** **01/2021 to 07/2023**
Howard University Beltsville Campus **Beltsville MD**
- Collaborated with an international research team to analyze atmospheric particulate data from La Paz and El Alto, Bolivia, investigating its role in glacier melt and climate impact.
 - Co-authored a published research book and presented findings at the American Meteorological Society, contributing to the global understanding of particulate matter's environmental effects.
- Researcher** **08/2022 to 05/2023**
Eleanor Roosevelt High School **Greenbelt MD**
- Learned effective research techniques, including evaluating credible sources, developing hypotheses, and applying structured research methods.
 - Wrote a multi-chapter research paper as the culmination of the program, presenting findings at the school's research symposium.

Education

- Bachelor: Mechanical Engineering** **Expected in 05/2027**
Cornell University **Ithaca, NY**
- Relevant Coursework: Introductory Fluid Mechanics, System Dynamics, Introduction to Aeronautics, Mechanics of Engineering Materials, Introduction to Mechanical Engineering, Multivariable Calculus, Thermodynamics, Statics and Mechanics of Solids, Differential Equations
- Science and Technology Program** **05/2023**
Eleanor Roosevelt High School **Greenbelt, MD**
- Weighted Cumulative GPA: 4.309, Unweighted Cumulative GPA: 4.0
 - Relevant Coursework: AP Computer Science Java, Honors Engineering Foundations, AP Calculus AB, Honors Foundations of Technology, AP Physics C, and AP Environmental Science

Extracurricular Activities

American Society of Mechanical Engineers, Member, 04/2025 - PRESENT | National Society of Black Engineers, Member, 08/2023 - PRESENT; Senator, 07/2025 - PRESENT | Cornell Black Students United, Member, 08/2023 - PRESENT; Secretary, 07/2025 - PRESENT | VEX Robotics Club, Team Leader, 08/2019 - 05/2020 | Environmental Defense Club, Member, 01/2021 - 05/2023 | Girls Who Code, Member, 01/2022 - 05/2023 | Science Olympiad, Member, 01/2021 - 05/2023 | National Honors Society, Member, 01/2022 - PRESENT

Achievements

- Awarded the VEX Robotics Competition Judges Award and Design Award in state competition, 2019
- Science Olympiad team competed in state championship, 2023
- 2nd place in high school math competition, 2023

Engineering Projects

Immersive Virtual Conferencing Device – Contributed to the design of a device that enhances virtual meetings, making platforms like Zoom feel more immersive through mechanical and sensor integration.

Tidy Twist – Developed a portable liquid dispenser to organize and dispense liquids for travelers.

VEX Robotics Robot – Designed and built a robot capable of placing cubes in towers and stacking cubes in corners for competitive robotics, applying mechanical design principles.